

The first and foremost task for anyone interested in developing iOS, OS X and watchOS apps and distributing them on the App Store would be to register their Apple ID under the Apple Developer Program. Mind you, if you're solely interested in trying out app development and are not interested in shelling out \$99/year as membership fees, you don't need to sign up for the program. You'll have to go to Xcode -> preferences and enter your Apple ID to register your Xcode account. However, with the free membership, you get access to Xcode Developer Tools, Xcode Beta Releases, Developer Forums, Bug Reporting and Device Testing. However, if you're interested in publishing your App to the App store, you'll have to pay a membership fee of \$99/ year. In addition to App Store Distribution, you also receive beta OS releases, advanced app capabilities and permissions, a developer ID and app analytics. Signing up for the Apple Developer program is easy. Visit <https://developer.apple.com/programs/enroll/> and sign up for the program as an individual. You'll need an Apple ID before you can proceed to the next screen.



If you intend to stick to the free membership, there's no need to go beyond this. Only if you intend to sign up for the paid program should you complete any of the further steps.

On the next screen, you'll be asked to select whether you intend to plan as an individual developer or as an organisation.

You'll also get a chance to verify your Apple ID and connected information on the screen after that. To avoid any hassles, make sure your Apple ID already has the connected credit card information and shipping address details. You can now complete your purchase of an Apple Developer Account on the next screen, by clicking on the 'Purchase' button.

If you've successfully completed all the given steps, you should have no problem moving on to the next task – installing Xcode on your Mac device.

For those with OS X 10.6 and above, installing Xcode is a breeze. Open the App Store in your browser, search for Xcode, following which you'll be presented with this screen. Click on "View in Mac App Store". It should automatically launch the "App Store" app on your Mac and take you the Xcode page. Click on the "Free" button, then click on "Install App."